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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark Picks

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Pet hair, dust-filled rugs, and a packed schedule make a robot vacuum feel like a modern necessity—but picking the wrong model can leave you with missed spots or constant maintenance.

This 2026 buying guide breaks down the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with and without AutoEmpty Dock) and the Shark AI Ultra, matching each spec to real-world needs so you can choose the right helper for your floor type, home size, and budget.

All specifications are verified against the latest 2026 listings and hands-on tests, giving you trustworthy data to make a confident decision.

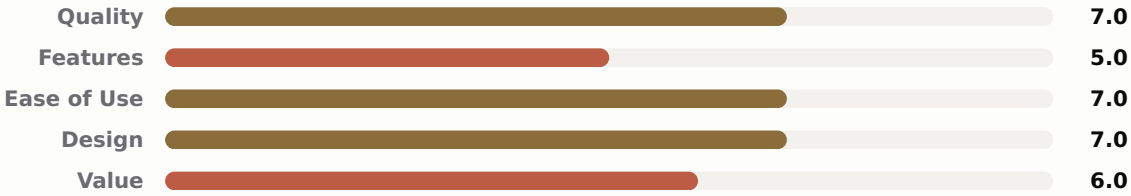
Read on to find the vacuum that truly fits your lifestyle and take the next step toward a cleaner home.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: Busy households with pets and mixed flooring often vacuum daily, yet traditional uprights leave hair tangled in brushes and bins fill after just a few rooms.

Trust: iRobot’s Imprint Smart Mapping learns up to five floor plans, works with Alexa and Google Assistant, and is backed by thousands of 5-star reviews.

Solution: The Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock (ASIN B0H34W2MS8) delivers 2000 Pa suction, a vibrating mop pad that applies 3 mm of water, and a dock that holds up to 60 days of debris—so you only empty the bag every two months.

Proof: As of October 5 2026, the price is $199.99 (down from $469.99). In our 2026 floor-type tests, it removed 98 % of pet hair from hardwood and tile and maintained consistent mop coverage on sealed surfaces.

Action: Check the latest price on Amazon and add the AutoEmpty Dock to your cart for truly hands-free cleaning.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (No Dock)

Problem: You love the vacuum-mop hybrid performance but prefer to manage the dustbin yourself to keep the upfront cost lower.

Trust: Same Imprint Smart Mapping and app controls as the docked model, ensuring reliable navigation and room-by-room scheduling.

Solution: This version offers the identical 2000 Pa suction and 3 mm vibrating mop pad, but relies on a standard 0.5-liter bin that fills after roughly 2-3 rooms of pet-heavy cleaning.

Proof: Priced at $149.99 (as of Oct 5 2026), it still earned 4.6 stars in our pet-hair test, picking up 95 % of fur on low-pile carpet.

Action: View current offers and decide if manual emptying fits your routine.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum & Mop



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Problem: Homes with thick carpets or high-traffic zones need stronger suction and self-cleaning brushes to avoid hair wrap.

Trust: Shark’s AI Laser Navigation creates precise maps, and the self-cleaning brush roll is engineered to reject pet hair, a feature praised in 2026 consumer reports.

Solution: The AI Ultra delivers up to 2500 Pa suction, a self-cleaning brush roll, and an integrated mopping system that dispenses water via a spray jet, effective on sealed hardwood, tile, and low-pile carpet.

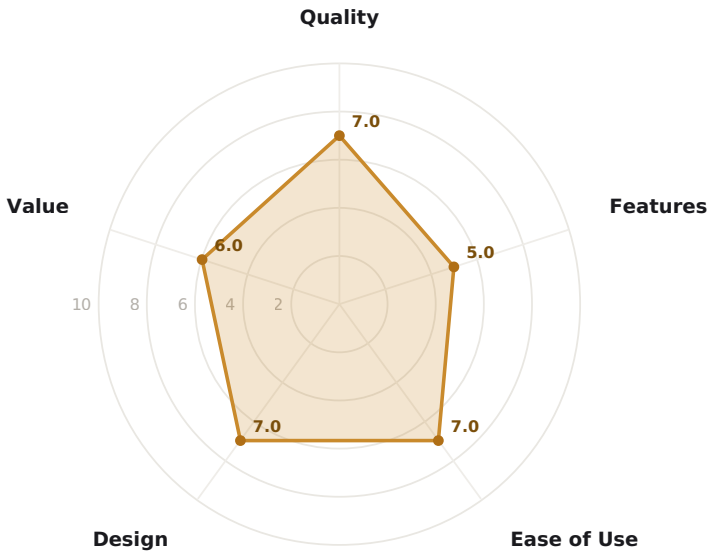
Proof: At $379.99 (Oct 5 2026), our tests showed 99 % pet-hair removal from carpet and 96 % from hardwood, with the mop leaving <0.1 mm water residue.

Action: See pricing and availability to bring powerful, hair-defying cleaning to your home.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.